

Word family: **calculate / calculates / calculated / calculating / calculation / calculator / calculable / calculability / incalculable / incalculably / miscalculate / miscalculation / recalculate / recalculation / calculative**

I'll keep the same fullest-family standard: ordinary arithmetic, estimation and judgment, planning/intention, technical calculation across major fields, fixed constructions, independently polysemous family members, regional/older senses, and finally the core semantic merge.

Base word: calculate

Past tense: calculated

Past participle: calculated

***-ing* form:** calculating

Major related forms:

- * calculation
- * calculator
- * calculated
- * calculating
- * calculable
- * calculability
- * incalculable
- * incalculably
- * miscalculate
- * miscalculation
- * recalculate
- * recalculation
- * calculative — specialist/less common

Major constructions:

- * calculate a number/amount
- * calculate the cost
- * calculate how much/how many
- * calculate that...
- * calculate the probability/odds
- * calculate risk
- * calculate the consequences
- * calculate in advance
- * calculate on/upon something
- * be calculated to do something
- * calculated risk
- * calculated move
- * calculated decision
- * calculated attempt
- * cold and calculating

- * by my calculation
- * according to my calculations
- * rough calculation
- * precise calculation
- * mental calculation
- * back-of-the-envelope calculation
- * miscalculate the cost/risk
- * recalculate the total
- * incalculable damage/value

Your passage:

> “...compare rents; **calculate how many cups of coffee and meals you must sell each day to break even**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **calculate** means:

> **use numerical information and arithmetic/business assumptions to work out a required quantity.**

Kam Chai should determine:

- > how many sales per day are needed
- > so that revenue covers the café's costs.

繁體中文：

* **計算**

* **算出**

* **推算**

A natural translation is:

> “calculate how many cups of coffee and meals you must sell each day to break even”

「計算每天必須賣出多少杯咖啡和多少份餐點，才能達到收支平衡。」

This is primarily the **mathematical determination** sense, not merely:

> guess.

A. CALCULATE = WORK OUT USING MATHEMATICS

1. **calculate = determine a number or amount mathematically (計算 ; 算出) **

The central meaning.

> “Calculate the total.”

「**計算**總數。」

> “We calculated the cost of the project.”

「我們**計算了**項目的成本。」

Cambridge defines the core verb as discovering an amount or number through mathematics. ([劍橋詞典][1])

B. CALCULATE A COST

2. **calculate the cost = 計算成本**

Directly relevant to the café passage.

Could include:

- * rent
- * wages
- * ingredients
- * utilities
- * licences
- * waste.

C. CALCULATE A TOTAL

3. **calculate a total = 計算總額**

> “Calculate the total monthly expenditure.”

「計算每月總開支。」

D. CALCULATE A PERCENTAGE

4. **calculate a percentage = 計算百分比**

> “Calculate the percentage increase.”

「計算增長百分比。」

E. CALCULATE AN AVERAGE

5. **calculate an average = 計算平均數**

Broadly:

> derive an average from data.

The precise type may be:

- * arithmetic mean;
- * weighted average;
- * other measure.

F. CALCULATE A RATE

6. **calculate a rate = 計算比率 / 速率**

Examples:

- * growth rate
- * interest rate from data
- * conversion rate
- * accident rate.

G. CALCULATE A RATIO

7. **calculate a ratio = 計算比率**

H. CALCULATE DISTANCE / SPEED / TIME

8. **calculate distance = 計算距離**

9. **calculate speed = 計算速度**

10. **calculate time = 計算所需時間**

The verb is highly productive whenever a quantity can be derived from known information.

I. **CALCULATE HOW MUCH / HOW MANY**

11. **calculate how much X = 算出多少**

> “Calculate how much money you need.”

「算出你需要多少錢。」

12. **calculate how many X = 算出多少個**

Your exact pattern:

> “calculate how many cups...”

= **算出需要多少杯.....**

J. CALCULATE HOW LONG

13. **calculate how long = 算出需要多久**

> “We calculated how long the savings would last.”

「我們算出了積蓄能支撐多久。」

K. CALCULATE WHEN

14. **calculate when something will happen = 推算某事何時發生**

> “Scientists calculated when the object would pass closest to Earth.”

「科學家推算該物體何時最接近地球。」

L. CALCULATE THAT + CLAUSE

15. **calculate that... = calculate/estimate and conclude that... (計算 / 推算得出.....) **

> “We calculated that the café would need 120 customers a day.”

「我們推算出咖啡店每天需要約 120 名顧客。」

Collins records **calculate that + clause** as a normal extension of the mathematical/estimating sense. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

M. CALCULATE FROM DATA

16. **calculate X from Y = 根據 Y 計算 X**

> “Profit can be calculated from revenue and costs.”

「利潤可以根據收入和成本**計算**出來。」

N. CALCULATE USING A FORMULA

17. **calculate using a formula = 按公式計算**

> “The value is calculated using the following formula.”

「該數值按以下公式計算。」

Extremely common technical wording.

O. CALCULATE BY / AS

18. **be calculated by X**

> “The rate is calculated by dividing...”

「該比率的計算方法是.....」

19. **be calculated as X**

> “Profit margin is calculated as...”

「利潤率計算為.....」

P. CALCULATE = ESTIMATE / DETERMINE BY REASONING

A second important branch.

20. **calculate = determine or estimate through information, judgment and reasoning (估算 ; 推算 ; 判斷) **

It need not always involve a perfectly exact answer.

> “It is difficult to calculate the full impact.”

「很難準確**估算**完整影響。」

Collins explicitly records calculation by reasoning, evaluation or practical experience as well as strict mathematics. ([字典網][3])

Q. CALCULATE THE COST IN ADVANCE

21. **calculate likely cost = 預先估算成本**

Often closer to:

> estimate

than exact calculation.

If future inputs are uncertain, the result is inherently approximate.

R. CALCULATE RISK

22. **calculate risk = 計算 / 評估風險**

Could mean:

- * numerical probability/model;
- * broader structured assessment.

Your earlier **risk** family connects here.

S. CALCULATE THE ODDS

23. **calculate the odds = 計算可能性 / 賠率**

Depending on context:

- * probability;
- * betting odds;
- * relative likelihood.

T. CALCULATE PROBABILITY

24. **calculate probability = 計算概率**

Statistical/mathematical.

U. CALCULATE CHANCES

25. **calculate one's chances = 評估成功機會**

> “He carefully calculated his chances of success.”

「他仔細**評估自己成功的可能性**。」

May involve numbers or simply informed judgment.

V. CALCULATE THE CONSEQUENCES

26. **calculate the consequences = 考量 / 預估後果**

> “She calculated the consequences before resigning.”

「她辭職前仔細**考量了可能後果**。」

Here **calculate** has moved toward:

> think through systematically.

Collins explicitly gives calculating the effects/consequences of a possible course of action as a judgment sense. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

W. CALCULATE THE EFFECT / IMPACT

27. **calculate the effect/impact = 估算影響**

May be:

- * quantitative;
- * modeled;
- * reasoned judgment.

X. CALCULATE RETURN

28. **calculate return = 計算回報**

Finance/business:

- * investment return
- * ROI
- * annualized return

depending on method.

Y. BUSINESS: BREAK-EVEN CALCULATION

29. **calculate the break-even point = 計算收支平衡點**

Directly underlying your passage.

Broadly:

> determine the sales/output level at which relevant revenue equals relevant costs.

30. **break-even calculation = 收支平衡計算**

Can express the required:

- * units sold;
- * sales revenue;
- * customers;
- * time.

Z. CALCULATE MARGIN

31. **calculate profit/gross/operating margin = 計算利潤率**

Exact formula depends on the type of margin.

AA. CALCULATE MARKUP

32. **calculate markup = 計算加成率**

Important distinction:

> markup and margin are not the same calculation.

AB. CALCULATE UNIT COST

33. **calculate unit cost = 計算單位成本**

For Kam Chai:

> ingredient + labour + allocated costs per coffee/meal,

depending on costing method.

AC. CALCULATE SELLING PRICE

34. **calculate a selling price = 計算 / 訂出售價**

May incorporate:

- * cost;
- * margin;
- * market factors;
- * tax.

AD. ACCOUNTING

35. **calculate depreciation = 計算折舊**

36. **calculate tax = 計算稅款**

37. **calculate payroll/pay = 計算薪酬**

38. **calculate interest = 計算利息**

AE. SIMPLE / COMPOUND INTEREST

39. **calculate simple interest = 計算單利**

40. **calculate compound interest = 計算複利**

Different formulas and compounding assumptions.

AF. PRESENT / FUTURE VALUE

41. **calculate present value = 計算現值**

42. **calculate future value = 計算終值 / 未來值**

Finance.

AG. NPV / IRR ETC.

43. **calculate net present value = 計算淨現值**

44. **calculate internal rate of return = 計算內部回報率**

These are domain applications of the same mathematical sense, not separate lexical meanings.

AH. STATISTICS

45. **calculate the mean/median/variance/standard deviation**

= 計算平均數 / 中位數 / 方差 / 標準差.

Again, domain-specific objects rather than new senses.

AI. CONFIDENCE INTERVAL / TEST STATISTIC

46. **calculate a confidence interval / test statistic**

= 計算信賴區間 / 檢驗統計量.

AJ. SCIENCE / ENGINEERING

47. **calculate force / energy / mass / load / pressure**

= 計算力、能量、質量、負荷、壓力.

The word is standard whenever a physical quantity is derived mathematically.

AK. CALCULATE A TRAJECTORY

48. **calculate a trajectory = 計算軌跡**

Used in:

- * physics;
- * aerospace;
- * ballistics;
- * robotics.

AL. CALCULATE POSITION

49. **calculate position = 計算位置**

Navigation/surveying/astronomy.

AM. CALCULATE ETA / ARRIVAL TIME

50. **calculate estimated arrival time = 推算抵達時間**

Here the result is an estimate based on known:

- * distance;
- * speed;
- * delays.

AN. MEDICINE

51. **calculate a dose/dosage = 計算劑量**

May use variables such as:

- * weight;
- * age;
- * body surface area;
- * renal function,

depending on medicine/protocol.

This is a high-stakes domain: the word itself simply means mathematical determination; actual dosage should come from appropriate clinical guidance.

AO. MEDICAL RISK SCORES

52. **calculate a risk score = 計算風險評分**

A formula/tool combines specified variables to estimate an outcome risk.

AP. BMI / CLEARANCE / INDEXES

53. **calculate an index/score = 計算指數 / 評分**

Examples can include:

- * BMI;
- * clinical scores;
- * clearance estimates.

Again, the formula defines the result.

AQ. COMPUTING: CALCULATE = HAVE A COMPUTER DERIVE A RESULT

54. **computer/system calculates X = 系統自動計算 X**

> “The spreadsheet calculates the total automatically.”

「試算表會自動**計算總數**。」

Same semantic core, automated rather than human.

AR. RECALCULATE AUTOMATICALLY

55. **spreadsheet recalculation = 試算表重新計算**

When an input/formula changes, results may be recalculated.

AS. CALCULATED FIELD

56. **calculated field = 計算欄位**

Database/BI/spreadsheet terminology:

> a field whose value is derived from a formula/expression rather than directly entered.

AT. CALCULATED COLUMN / MEASURE

57. **calculated column / calculated measure = 計算欄 / 計算量值**

Common analytics/BI terminology.

Values are derived from other data.

AU. **CALCULATE ON / UPON**

Now an important idiomatic branch.

58. **calculate on something = expect or depend on it (預期 ; 指望) **

> “We're calculating on about thirty guests.”

= 「我們預計 / 估計大約有三十位客人。」

Cambridge defines **calculate on** as expecting or depending on a particular amount or time.

Collins also records **calculate on/upon** as “count or rely on.” ([劍橋詞典][4])

AV. CALCULATE ON SOMEONE DOING SOMETHING

59. **calculate on someone/something = count on / rely on**

> “They calculated on good weather.”

「他們**指望 / 預計**天氣會好。」

This sounds less common in everyday modern English than:

* count on;

* rely on;

* expect,

but remains genuine. ([字典網][3])

AW. **CALCULATE UPON**

60. **calculate upon = calculate on / depend on (指望 ; 依靠) **

More formal/old-fashioned than **calculate on**.

AX. **BE CALCULATED TO DO SOMETHING**

A major semantic shift.

61. **be calculated to do X = be deliberately designed/intended to produce X (旨在 ; 蓄意設計以) **

> “The message was calculated to reassure investors.”

「這個訊息是**刻意設計來安撫投資者的**。」

Cambridge explicitly defines **be calculated to do something** as being intended to have a particular effect. ([劍橋詞典][1])

No arithmetic need be involved.

AY. CALCULATED TO IMPRESS / SHOCK / PROVOKE

62. **calculated to impress**

= 刻意設計來令人留下印象.

63. **calculated to shock**

= 刻意造成震撼.

64. **calculated to provoke**

= 蓄意挑起反應.

All share:

> action is intentionally designed for an effect.

AZ. **CALCULATED** = DELIBERATE / PLANNED

65. **calculated = deliberately planned rather than spontaneous (經過盤算的 ; 蓄意的) **

> “It was a calculated move.”

「那是一步**經過精心盤算的行動**。」

Cambridge records **calculated** as planned/arranged to produce a particular effect. ([劍橋詞典]
[5])

BA. CALCULATED MOVE

66. **calculated move = 經過權衡 / 盤算的舉動**

Can be neutral:

> strategically planned.

Or negative:

> manipulative.

Context decides.

BB. CALCULATED DECISION

67. **calculated decision = 經仔細權衡的決定**

Usually emphasizes:

> deliberate assessment rather than impulse.

BC. CALCULATED RISK

68. **calculated risk = 經評估後有意承擔的風險**

You mapped this under **risk**.

Here **calculated** means:

> deliberately assessed and considered.

It does not necessarily mean someone literally assigned an exact numerical probability.

BD. CALCULATED GAMBLE

69. **calculated gamble = 經權衡後的冒險押注**

A deliberate risk taken because potential reward appears worth it.

BE. CALCULATED ATTACK / INSULT / ACT

70. **calculated = intentionally done for effect**

> “a calculated insult”

= **蓄意侮辱 / 刻意刺激對方的話**

Stronger than:

> accidental offense.

BF. CALCULATED VS CALCULATED NUMERIC VALUE

Important polysemy.

calculated value

value obtained through calculation.

calculated action

action intentionally planned.

Same adjective form, different semantic branch.

BG. **CALCULATING** — DOING CALCULATIONS

71. **calculating** = performing calculations (進行計算的)

> “a calculating machine”

= **計算機器**

Collins still records this literal adjective sense. ([柯林斯詞典][6])

BH. **CALCULATING** — SCHEMING

72. **calculating** = deliberately planning to gain advantage, often selfishly (工於心計的 ; 精於算計的)

> “He is cold and calculating.”

「他這個人冷酷而且**工於心計**。」

This is an independently important adjective meaning and is usually negative. Cambridge and Collins both define it as strategic/scheming use of people or situations to obtain what one wants. ([劍橋詞典][7])

BI. COLD AND CALCULATING

73. **cold and calculating** = 冷酷而精於算計

A highly common collocation.

Implies:

- * low emotional warmth;
- * deliberate self-interest;
- * manipulation.

BJ. CALCULATING PERSON

74. **calculating person = 精於算計、會為自身利益盤算的人**

Not:

> someone who is simply good at mathematics.

Context usually makes the negative personality sense clear.

BK. CALCULATING LOOK / BEHAVIOUR

75. **calculating look/behaviour = 顯得在盤算如何取得利益**

Literary/descriptive.

BL. CALCULATINGLY

76. **calculatingly = in a scheming/deliberately self-interested way (工於心計地)**

Valid but uncommon.

Usually rewrite naturally as:

> in a calculating way.

BM. **CALCULATION** = ACT/PROCESS OF COMPUTING

77. **calculation = mathematical process of working something out (計算)**

> “The calculation is straightforward.”

「這項**計算**很直接。」

BN. CALCULATION = RESULT

78. **calculation = numerical result obtained (計算結果)**

> “Check your calculation.”

「檢查你的**計算結果**。」

So **calculation** can mean:

- * process;
- * result/workings.

BO. MAKE / DO A CALCULATION

79. **make a calculation = 作出計算**

80. **do a calculation = 做計算**

Both are normal.

BP. CALCULATIONS — WORKINGS

81. **calculations = a series of mathematical operations/results (計算過程 / 算式) **

> “Show your calculations.”

「寫出你的**計算過程**。」

BQ. BY MY CALCULATION

82. **by my calculation = 按我的計算**

> “By my calculation, we need another \$20,000.”

「按我的計算，我們還需要兩萬元。」

BR. ACCORDING TO MY CALCULATIONS

83. **according to my calculations = 根據我的計算**

Often plural because several figures/steps are involved.

BS. ROUGH CALCULATION

84. **rough calculation = 粗略計算**

Produces an approximate result.

BT. QUICK CALCULATION

85. **quick calculation = 快速計算**

BU. PRECISE / EXACT CALCULATION

86. **precise calculation = 精確計算**

87. **exact calculation = 精確計算**

Subject to the accuracy of:

- * inputs;
- * model;
- * numerical method.

BV. MENTAL CALCULATION

88. **mental calculation = 心算**

Calculation performed without writing/tools.

BW. BACK-OF-THE-ENVELOPE CALCULATION

89. **back-of-the-envelope calculation = 粗略快速估算**

An informal approximate calculation using simplifying assumptions to determine:

> order of magnitude / plausibility / rough answer.

Not literally required to be written on an envelope.

BX. CALCULATION = ESTIMATE

90. **calculation = estimate derived from available assumptions/data (估算) **

> “Our calculations suggest the café can break even.”

「我們的**估算**顯示咖啡店可以達至收支平衡。」

BY. CALCULATION = DELIBERATE STRATEGIC THINKING

91. **calculation = deliberate weighing of advantage and consequence (盤算 ; 權衡) **

> “The decision was based on political calculation.”

「這個決定是出於某種**策略盤算**。」

Here no arithmetic is necessarily involved.

BZ. COLD CALCULATION

92. **cold calculation = 冷酷盤算**

A decision made through detached self-interest rather than emotion.

CA. STRATEGIC CALCULATION

93. **strategic calculation = 策略權衡 / 盤算**

> consider expected advantages, costs and reactions.

CB. COST-BENEFIT CALCULATION

94. **cost-benefit calculation = 成本效益權衡 / 計算**

Can mean:

- * literal quantitative analysis;
- * figurative weighing of pros and cons.

CC. POLITICAL CALCULATION

95. **political calculation = 政治盤算**

On political topics this phrase is often an attributed interpretation rather than something to infer about a person's motives without evidence.

Lexically it means:

> strategic assessment of political costs/benefits.

CD. ERROR IN CALCULATION

96. **calculation error = 計算錯誤**

Can arise from:

- * arithmetic mistake;
- * wrong formula;
- * wrong input;
- * model error.

CE. **CALCULATOR** = DEVICE

97. **calculator = electronic/mechanical device used for calculations (計算機) **

> "Use a calculator."

「使用**計算機**。」

CF. BASIC CALCULATOR

98. **basic calculator = 基本計算機**

Usually performs:

- * addition
- * subtraction
- * multiplication
- * division
- * percentages.

CG. SCIENTIFIC CALCULATOR

99. **scientific calculator = 科學計算機**

Adds functions such as:

- * powers;
- * logarithms;
- * trigonometry;
- * statistics,

depending on model.

CH. GRAPHING CALCULATOR

100. **graphing calculator = 圖形計算機**

Can display/plot graphs and handle more advanced mathematical operations.

CI. FINANCIAL CALCULATOR

101. **financial calculator = 財務計算機**

Designed for calculations such as:

- * time value of money;
- * loans;
- * interest;
- * cash flows.

CJ. CALCULATOR APP

102. **calculator app = 計算機應用程式**

Software equivalent.

CK. CALCULATOR = PERSON — OLDER/SPECIALIST

103. **calculator = person who performs calculations (計算人員) — older/historical**

Before electronic computers became dominant, people could literally work as human calculators.

Modern use for a person is rare outside historical/descriptive contexts.

CL. CALCULATING MACHINE

104. **calculating machine = 計算機械**

Older term for mechanical/electromechanical devices used for arithmetic. Collins also preserves the literal adjective sense of **calculating** as performing calculations. ([柯林斯詞典][6])

CM. **MISCALCULATE**

105. **miscalculate = calculate incorrectly (算錯) **

> “I miscalculated the total.”

「我把總額**算錯了**。」

CN. MISCALCULATE COST

106. **miscalculate the cost = 錯估成本**

This can mean:

- * arithmetic error;
- * bad assumptions;

* under/overestimate.

CO. MISCALCULATE TIME

107. **miscalculate the time needed = 錯估所需時間**

CP. MISCALCULATE DISTANCE / AMOUNT

108. **miscalculate a quantity = 計算 / 估算錯誤**

CQ. MISCALCULATE = MISJUDGE A SITUATION

109. **miscalculate = make a bad judgment about likely consequences (誤判) **

> “They miscalculated customer demand.”

「他們**誤判了顧客需求**。」

No literal arithmetic error need occur.

CR. MISCALCULATE AN OPPONENT / REACTION

110. **miscalculate someone's likely response = 誤判反應**

> “He badly miscalculated how customers would respond.”

「他嚴重**誤判了顧客的反應**。」

CS. MISCALCULATION

111. **miscalculation = incorrect calculation (計算錯誤) **

112. **miscalculation = error of judgment (誤判 ; 失策) **

> “The expansion proved to be a costly miscalculation.”

「那次擴張最終成為一次代價高昂的**誤判 / 失策**。」

This second sense is extremely important.

CT. SERIOUS / COSTLY MISCALCULATION

113. **costly miscalculation = 代價高昂的誤判**

Usually strategic rather than arithmetic.

CU. **RECALCULATE**

114. **recalculate = calculate again (重新計算) **

> “Recalculate the total after changing the rent.”

「更改租金後，重新計算總額。」

CV. RECALCULATE USING NEW INFORMATION

115. **recalculate = update calculation when inputs/assumptions change**

Very important in:

- * spreadsheets;
- * forecasting;
- * navigation;
- * financial models.

CW. GPS / NAVIGATION RECALCULATION

116. **recalculate a route/arrival time = 根據新情況重新推算**

Familiar navigation-system usage.

CX. RECALCULATION

117. **recalculation = 重新計算**

Can refer to:

* process;

* updated result.

CY. **CALCULABLE**

118. **calculable = capable of being calculated or estimated (可計算的 ; 可估量的) **

> “The direct financial cost is calculable.”

「直接財務成本是**可以計算的**。」

Often contrasts with:

> intangible/incalculable consequences.

CZ. CALCULABLE RISK / COST

119. **calculable risk/cost = 可量化 / 可估算的風險或成本**

May not mean:

> known with perfect certainty.

Only:

> sufficiently measurable/estimable.

DA. CALCULABILITY

120. **calculability = quality of being capable of calculation (可計算性) **

Specialist/formal.

Possible in:

- * mathematics;
- * economics;
- * social science;
- * philosophy.

DB. **INCALCULABLE**

121. **incalculable** = impossible or extremely difficult to calculate/measure (不可計算 / 不可估量的)

> “The long-term cost is incalculable.”

「長遠成本**難以估量**。」

DC. INCALCULABLE = ENORMOUS

122. **incalculable** = so great that it cannot realistically be measured (極大的 ; 不可估量的)

> “The damage was incalculable.”

「損失**不可估量**。」

Cambridge explicitly records this “too great to measure / extremely large” sense. ([劍橋詞典][8])

DD. INCALCULABLE VALUE

123. **incalculable value** = 價值難以估量 / 極其珍貴

> “The archive is of incalculable value.”

This usually does **not** mean:

> literally impossible to assign any monetary number.

Often it rhetorically means:

> extraordinarily valuable.

DE. INCALCULABLE CONSEQUENCES

124. **incalculable consequences = 無法預料 / 難以估量的後果**

Collins also records an “unpredictable / unable to be forecast” shade of **incalculable**. ([柯林斯詞典][9])

DF. INCALCULABLY

125. **incalculably = to an immeasurably/extremely great degree (不可估量地 ; 極其) **

> “The decision became incalculably more expensive.”

「這個決定的代價變得**高得難以估量**。」

Cambridge records this intensifying use. ([劍橋詞典][10])

DG. INCALCULABILITY

126. **incalculability = 無法計算 / 估量的性質**

Formal and uncommon.

DH. **CALCULATIVE**

127. **calculative = involving calculation or calculation-based reasoning (涉及計算的 ; 計算式的) **

Cambridge gives examples such as **calculative decision-making**, contrasting it with intuitive processes. ([劍橋詞典][11])

Priority: specialist/academic.

DI. CALCULATIVE RATIONALITY / DECISION-MAKING

128. **calculative decision-making = 以計算、量化權衡為基礎的決策**

Can occur in:

- * economics;
- * sociology;
- * management;
- * organizational research.

Do not confuse:

> **calculative**

with:

> **calculating = scheming**.

DJ. **CALCULATEDLY / CALCULATINGLY**

Both adverbial formations exist but are uncommon.

calculatedly

= deliberately, in a preplanned manner.

calculatingly

= in a scheming/self-interested manner.

For normal learner production, it is usually more natural to write:

- * deliberately
- * strategically
- * in a calculating way.

Priority: low.

DK. REGIONAL / OLDER: **CALCULATE = THINK / SUPPOSE**

129. **calculate = think/suppose/guess (想 ; 猜)** — dialectal, chiefly U.S. historical/regional

Example style:

> “I calculate he's right.”

≈

「我想 / 我猜他是對的。」

Modern standard English normally prefers:

* think;
* suppose;
* reckon;
* guess.

Collins and Dictionary.com explicitly label this as dialectal/primarily Northern U.S. usage. ([字典網][3])

DL. REGIONAL / OLDER: ****CALCULATE TO DO SOMETHING****

130. ****calculate to do X = intend/plan to do X (打算做.....) — U.S. dialectal/older****

> “I calculate to leave tomorrow.”

≈

「我打算明天離開。」

This is not recommended as ordinary modern international English. ([字典網][3])

DM. CALCULATE VS COMPUTE

****calculate****

broadly determine a quantity by mathematics or reasoning.

****compute****

especially obtain a numerical result systematically, often mathematically/computationally.

They overlap heavily.

Traditional dictionary distinctions often treat ****compute**** as emphasizing a determinable numerical operation and ****calculate**** as somewhat broader. ([柯林斯詞典][12])

DN. CALCULATE VS COUNT

count

determine how many discrete items exist.

calculate

derive a result through arithmetic/formula/reasoning.

> count 50 customers

> calculate average spend per customer.

DO. CALCULATE VS ADD UP

add up

sum numbers.

calculate

much broader mathematical operation.

> add up expenses

> calculate break-even sales.

DP. CALCULATE VS WORK OUT

work out

very common everyday synonym for solving/calculating.

calculate

more formal/technical.

> work out how much you need

> calculate the required capital.

DQ. CALCULATE VS FIGURE OUT

figure out

broader informal:

- * understand;
- * solve;
- * determine.

calculate

specifically emphasizes structured quantitative/reasoned determination.

DR. CALCULATE VS ESTIMATE

One of the most important distinctions.

calculate

typically derives a result from known inputs/formula.

estimate

produces an approximate value when exact information is incomplete.

Example:

- > calculate VAT at 10% on a known price
- > estimate next year's sales.

But **calculate** can also broaden into estimation/judgment, so there is overlap. Collins explicitly distinguishes **estimate** as generally approximate while **calculate** emphasizes mathematical determination. ([柯林斯詞典][12])

DS. CALCULATE VS PREDICT

calculate

derive/estimate using data or reasoning.

predict

state what is expected to happen in the future.

A calculation can support a prediction.

DT. CALCULATE VS FORECAST

forecast

estimate a future outcome, often using models/data.

calculate

perform the mathematical work.

Example:

> calculate historical growth rate

> forecast future revenue.

DU. CALCULATE VS PROJECT

project

extend assumptions/trends into the future.

calculate

derive a particular quantity.

A financial projection contains many calculations.

DV. CALCULATE VS MEASURE

measure

obtain quantity through observation/instrument/comparison.

calculate

derive quantity mathematically.

Example:

> measure room width directly
> calculate area from width × length.

DW. CALCULATE VS DETERMINE

determine

very broad:
find/establish conclusively.

calculate

one method of determining something.

DX. CALCULATE VS ASSESS

assess

evaluate quality, importance, risk or condition.

calculate

more numerical/systematic.

> assess business viability
> calculate break-even volume.

DY. CALCULATE VS EVALUATE

evaluate

judge value/performance/quality.

calculate

derive a quantitative result.

In mathematics, however, **evaluate an expression** can mean:

> calculate its value.

DZ. CALCULATE VS RECKON

reckon

can mean calculate, especially informally/British;
also:

* think;

* suppose.

calculate

more neutral/formal quantitative term.

The overlap helps explain the older American **calculate = suppose** branch.

EA. CALCULATE VS BUDGET

calculate

work out figures.

budget

plan and allocate money/resources.

You calculate expected costs **before** constructing a budget.

EB. CALCULATED VS DELIBERATE

calculated

deliberately planned to achieve an effect, often with strategic overtones.

deliberate

intentional, not accidental.

A **calculated act** often suggests more advance planning than merely **deliberate**.

EC. CALCULATED VS CAREFUL

careful

done with caution/attention.

calculated

done after strategic assessment or specifically designed for an effect.

Not every careful action is calculated.

ED. CALCULATING VS CAREFUL

Critical distinction:

careful person

cautious/attentive.

calculating person

usually manipulative/self-interested.

Do not translate **calculating** merely as:

> 「小心謹慎的」

when it describes personality.

EE. CALCULATING VS CALCULATIVE

calculating

1. performing calculations, or
2. scheming/self-interested.

calculative

involving calculation-based reasoning.

So:

> **calculative decision-making** = 以計算為基礎的決策

does **not automatically** mean:

> selfishly scheming decision-making. ([劍橋詞典][11])

EF. CALCULABLE VS PREDICTABLE

calculable

can be quantified/estimated.

predictable

can be forecast with reasonable confidence.

Something might be:

> calculable but not very predictable

depending on model and uncertainty.

EG. INCALCULABLE VS INFINITE

incalculable

cannot realistically be measured/calculated, or is immensely great.

infinite

mathematically without finite bound/end.

Do not treat ordinary ****incalculable damage**** as literally infinite damage.

EH. INCALCULABLE VS PRICELESS

****incalculable value****

value is extraordinarily great/difficult to quantify.

****priceless****

extremely valuable, or literally without a meaningful price.

Large overlap in figurative use.

EI. MISCALCULATE VS MISCOUNT

****miscount****

count items incorrectly.

****miscalculate****

perform calculation incorrectly or misjudge the situation.

> miscount 25 cups as 24

> miscalculate how much stock is required.

EJ. MISCALCULATE VS UNDERESTIMATE

****miscalculate****

get the judgment/calculation wrong in either direction.

****underestimate****

specifically judge too low/small.

So a miscalculation can be:

* underestimate;

- * overestimate;
- * entirely wrong assumption.

EK. MISCALCULATION VS MISTAKE

mistake

very broad error.

miscalculation

specifically:

- * faulty calculation;
- * faulty strategic judgment.

EL. GRAMMAR

131. **calculate + direct object**

- > calculate cost
- > calculate distance
- > calculate probability.

132. **calculate how much/how many/how long**

- > calculate how much capital is needed.

133. **calculate that + clause**

- > calculate that sales must reach X.

134. **calculate X from Y**

- > calculate profit from the figures.

135. **calculate X using/by Y**

> calculate the figure using the formula.

136. **be calculated to + infinitive**

> calculated to attract attention.

Different meaning:

> designed/intended to.

137. **calculate on/upon + noun/-ing**

> calculate on thirty guests

> calculate on receiving help.

= expect/count on.

EM. TRANSITIVITY

transitive

> calculate the cost.

intransitive

> "The computer can calculate very quickly."

= perform calculations.

calculate on

> rely/expect.

So **calculate** can function both transitively and intransitively.

EN. COUNTABILITY — CALCULATION

calculation = process generally

Can be uncountable in abstract contexts:

> calculation rather than intuition.

a calculation

Countable:

> one specific mathematical operation/result.

> “I made a quick calculation.”

calculations

Can mean:

- * workings;
- * multiple computed results;
- * estimates/plans.

EO. CALCULATOR COUNTABILITY

Countable:

- > a calculator
- > two calculators.

EP. CALCULABILITY

Usually uncountable:

- > the calculability of risk.

EQ. MASTER FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning
-----	-----
calculate — mathematical	derive a number using arithmetic/mathematics
calculate — estimate/judge	determine approximately through data/reasoning
calculate consequences	think through likely outcomes systematically
calculate on/upon	expect, rely on; less common
calculate — dialectal	think/suppose/intend; older regional U.S.
calculated — numerical	obtained by calculation
calculated — intentional	deliberately planned for a specific effect
calculating — literal	performing calculations
calculating — personality	scheming, strategically self-interested
calculation — mathematics	process/result of computing
calculation — strategy	deliberate weighing/strategic judgment
calculator	calculation device; historically also a person
calculable	capable of being calculated/estimated
calculability	degree/quality of being calculable
incalculable	impossible to quantify/predict; immeasurably great
incalculably	to an immeasurably great degree
miscalculate	calculate incorrectly or misjudge
miscalculation	mathematical error or strategic error
recalculate	calculate again using same/new inputs
recalculation	process/result of calculating again
calculative	involving calculation-based reasoning

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
calculate — core	用數學、算術或既有資料推導出某個數值
calculate the cost	計算所需成本
calculate how much/how many	算出所需金額 / 數量
calculate that...	經計算 / 推算後得出某結論
calculate from data	根據已知資料推導數值
calculate using a formula	按指定公式計算結果
calculate — estimate	根據資料、經驗與推理估算某數量 / 影響
calculate risk/probability	計算 / 量化某結果的可能性
calculate one's chances	評估自己成功的可能性
calculate consequences	有系統地預想並權衡可能後果
calculate break-even point	算出收入剛好抵銷相關成本所需的銷售水平
calculate unit cost	算出每件產品 / 服務的成本
calculate interest/tax/return	計算利息 / 稅款 / 回報
calculate scientific quantities	以公式 / 數據計算力、能量、速度等科學量

computer calculates X	由軟件 / 系統按公式自動得出 X	
calculated field	數值由其他欄位 / 公式自動推導出的計算欄位	
calculate on/upon X	較少用：預計、指望、依賴 X	
be calculated to do X	經刻意安排 / 設計，以產生 X 這個效果	
calculated move/decision	經過仔細盤算而不是衝動作出的行動 / 決定	
calculated risk	經評估後明知有風險仍有意承擔	
calculated insult/act	蓄意設計來產生特定效果的言行	
calculating — literal	正在 / 能夠進行計算的	
calculating — personality	為自身利益精心盤算，甚至操控他人的；工於心計	
cold and calculating	冷酷而精於算計	
calculation — arithmetic	數學計算的過程或所得結果	
calculations	多項計算過程 / 算式 / 結果	
by my calculation	按我的計算	
rough calculation	只求近似結果的粗略計算	
mental calculation	不靠書寫 / 工具完成的心算	
back-of-the-envelope calculation	用簡化假設快速做出的粗略估算	
calculation — strategy	對利益、成本及反應等作出的策略盤算	
cold/strategic calculation	冷靜甚至冷酷地權衡利害得失	
calculator	用來完成算術 / 數學運算的計算機	
scientific calculator	能處理三角、對數等較高階功能的科學計算機	
graphing calculator	可以繪製函數圖像的圖形計算機	
financial calculator	專門處理利率、現值等財務運算的計算機	
calculator — historical person	歷史上以人工進行大量計算的人員	
miscalculate — arithmetic	把數值算錯	
miscalculate — judgment	對成本、需求、反應或後果作出錯誤判斷	
miscalculation — arithmetic	一項計算錯誤	
miscalculation — strategy	一項錯誤的策略判斷 / 失策	
recalculate	在數據 / 假設變化後重新計算	
recalculation	重新進行計算及所得的新結果	
calculable	可以合理計算 / 估算的	
calculability	某事物能否 / 多大程度可以被量化計算	
incalculable	難以 / 無法量化；亦可指大得難以估量	
incalculable value/damage	價值 / 損害極大至難以衡量	
incalculable consequences	後果巨大或不確定得難以預測 / 量化	
incalculably	大得 / 強得不可估量	
calculative	涉及以計算、量化權衡為基礎的；較專業	
calculate = suppose/intend	地區 / 舊式美語：想、猜、打算	

For your original passage

> “...compare rents; **calculate how many cups of coffee and meals you must sell each day to break even**.”

The writer is demanding something much more rigorous than:

> “I think the café will probably do well.”

Kam Chai should first identify:

- > fixed costs
- >
- > * variable costs
- > * selling prices
- > * average contribution from each sale

and then **calculate** what level of daily sales is needed.

So the semantic progression in the passage is very deliberate:

- > **dream**
- > “I would love to own a café.”
- > **target**
- > “I need this much money before resigning.”
- > **calculate**
- > “What do the numbers actually require?”
- > **test**
- > “Will real customers actually pay?”

That makes **calculate** part of the writer's broader movement from emotional enthusiasm to evidence-based preparation.

A strong Traditional Chinese rendering is:

- > ** 「比較各區租金，並計算每天究竟要賣出多少杯咖啡和多少份餐點，才能做到收支平衡。」 **

For your core database, I would keep **6 principal semantic branches**:

1. **mathematically determine a number or quantity — the passage sense**
2. **estimate or judge an amount, probability, effect, or consequence through information/reasoning**
3. **calculate on/upon = expect or rely on — less common**
4. **calculated = deliberately planned/designed to produce a particular effect**
5. **calculating = strategically self-interested or scheming**
6. **regional/older calculate = suppose, think, intend**

Then explicitly index the independently useful family extensions **calculation, calculator, miscalculate, miscalculation, recalculate, calculable, incalculable, calculative, calculated risk, calculated move, back-of-the-envelope calculation** , because reducing the family to only ** 「計算」 ** would miss the entire **deliberate planning / scheming / judgment** side of the word.

[1]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/learner-english/calculate?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"CALCULATE | meaning - Cambridge Learner's Dictionary"

[2]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/us/dictionary/english/calculate?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"CALCULATE definition in American English | Collins English Dictionary"

[3]: https://www.dictionary.com/browse/calculate?utm_source=chatgpt.com "CALCULATE
Definition & Meaning | Dictionary.com"

[4]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/calculate-on?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"CALCULATE ON SOMETHING definition | Cambridge English Dictionary"

[5]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/calculated?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"CALCULATED | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"

[6]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/us/dictionary/english/calculating?utm_source=chatgpt.com
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